

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

19th March, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

12th WEEK



VIENNA CONVENTION
ON DIPLOMATIC RELATIONS

EXPULSION OF DIPLOMATS

UPSC CSE – GS III

GS III ... Role of External State and Non state Actors in creating Challenges to Internal Security.

Russia spy poisoning: What happens when you expel a diplomat?



The UK has also cut off high-level contacts with Russia after the Salisbury nerve agent attack

Russia has decided to expel 23 UK diplomats, in a tit-for-tat response to the UK's expulsion of 23 of its diplomats.

The British government announced plans to expel the Russian diplomats as part of its response to the Salisbury nerve agent attack.

But why do countries expel diplomats? And what happens when a diplomat is told to leave the country?

The British government announced plans to expel the Russian diplomats as part of its response to the Salisbury nerve agent attack.

But why do countries expel diplomats? And what happens when a diplomat is told to leave the country?

- Russia to expel 23 UK diplomats in spy row
- Why the UK is expelling diplomats

Why do countries expel diplomats?

Diplomats around the world are granted immunity in their host country - meaning they cannot be prosecuted there.

However, their right to stay in the host country can be withdrawn if they break the law, upset the host nation - or in the event of a diplomatic crisis, as between the UK and Russia right now.

The Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations governs how states interact. Under article 9 of the convention, the host country can "at any time and for any reason" declare a person to be persona non grata - unwelcome in their country.

Who decides who goes?

The host government decides which diplomats go and which ones stay.

The British ambassador was summoned by Russia on Saturday, and had to go and break the news to his staff. This is what the UK did to the Russian ambassador, and what has happened in the past.

- UK and Malawi diplomats expelled

However John Everard, former UK ambassador to North Korea, says there is "no fixed way of telling diplomats" who stays and who goes.

Countries can summon the ambassador or issue a formal diplomatic note, he says. There is no law governing how to do it.

The Skripals in Salisbury

Britain's politics and diplomacy are in turmoil after the attack on a Russian double agent



VIDYA RAM

When asked to defend his response in the U.K. Parliament to Prime Minister Theresa May's condemnation of the "unlawful use of force" by the Russian state against Britain, Labour Party leader Jeremy Corbyn told a television channel last week, "What I was asking were questions... That's what Oppositions are there for." An appetite for scrutiny appeared to be severely lacking in the British establishment as Mr. Corbyn was excoriated by those within and outside his party for failing to immediately endorse Mr. May's stance. Instead, he asked whether the government had responded to Russia's requests for a sample of the nerve agent, and whether there still remained a possibility that Russia had "negligently lost control" of the military-grade nerve agent, which Britain believes was used against former double agent Sergei Skripal and his daughter Yulia. Though rhetoric appeared to be the order of the day as Foreign Secretary Boris Johnson virtually accused Russian President Vladimir Putin of masterminding the Salisbury attack, while Defence Secretary Gavin Williamson chided aside diplomatic norms and told Russia to "go away" and "shut up".

being part of Russia's Novichok nerve agent programme (dating back to the Soviet days), there were only two possibilities: either the nerve agent, judged to be several times as powerful as VX or Sarin, had been deployed by the Russian state or had fallen out of its hands.

Russia's reaction, alongside denying the allegations, has been to question the methods deployed by the U.K. in its response. The setting of a midnight deadline for Russia to "explain itself" didn't follow the protocol established under the Organisation for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons (OPCW) Convention, for a joint investigation before judgment is passed. Speaking during the hastily arranged meeting of the United Nations Security Council, Russia's Vladimir Putin accused Britain of being afraid of a "genuine professional discussion on the topic" by choosing the political forum of the Security Council rather than the expert body at The Hague to level its accusations and seek backing. It was also just last year that the OPCW, winner of the 2013 Nobel Peace Prize, participated in a ceremony on the completion of operations at the Khimik Chemical Weapons Destruction Facility, marking the full destruction of 20,967 metric tonnes of chemical weapons that the Soviet Union had possessed.

The landmark should have raised questions, given Britain's very recent past, and the Chilcot report in particular. Published in July 2016, the



The nerve toxin attack on double agent Sergei Skripal and his daughter Yulia has led to a full blown diplomatic crisis between Russia and the U.K. Personal leave after swabbing railings at the shopping centre in Salisbury where the two were found unconscious on a bench.

damning report by Sir John Chilcot pointed to grave errors made by British intelligence services in their assessment of Saddam Hussein's alleged weapons of mass destruction programme, which was used to make the case for the second Iraq War in 2003. "At no stage was the proposition that Iraq might no longer have chemical, biological or nuclear weapons or programmes identified and examined," the report noted.

Mr. Corbyn said in an article in The Guardian last week, "I have seen clear thinking in an international crisis overwhelmed by emotion and hasty judgments too many times. Flawed intelligence and dodgy dossier led to the calamity of the Iraq invasion." He warned against resignation to a "new cold war of escalating arms spending, proxy conflicts across the globe and a McCarthyite intolerance of dissent."

Predictably, Mr. Corbyn has been accused of a long standing softness towards Russia. This is particularly ironic as it is the Labour Party that has been pushing for a toughening of Britain's ability to impose sanctions on individuals, through the introduction of legislation on par with the U.S. Magnitsky Act. Named after an auditor who uncovered massive tax fraud but died in detention in Russia, the law allows asset freezes and denial of visas to those accused of human rights abuses, and was signed into law by former U.S. President Barack Obama in 2012. "We must also

expose the flows of ill-gotten cash between the Russian state and billionaires who become stupendously rich by looting their country and subsequently use London to protect their wealth," Mr. Corbyn told MPs.

Questions to both countries Without doubt, there are many questions that need to be asked of Russia. Alongside the 2006 poisoning of former FSB officer Alexander Litvinenko, 14 deaths in London over the past 10 years have been linked to Russia. A BuzzFeed investigation said these deaths had raised suspicions among U.S. intelligence figures, despite not being ruled as suspicious by British police forces. On Friday, police launched a murder investigation into the death of Nikolai Glushko, a Kremlin critic, at his home in London though there is no evidence linking this to the illness of the Skripals.

An interview with Val Mirzayants, a Russian scientist who alerted the West to the existence of Novichok when he defected in the 1990s, told the Voice of America last week that since the programme had not been declared to the OPCW, it would not have the tools to detect it.

But there are many issues that need to be raised in Britain too. Can it truly exclude the possibility of the agent coming from another source or having fallen into the hands of others? And what is the logic of Russia taking action against a former double agent, who was one of 10 agents who had been returned to the West in a spy swap eight years ago? What role could the presidential elections and the forthcoming FIFA World Cup in Russia (now not to be attended by British officials or members of the Royal Family) have played in any decision to act?

Crucially, is Britain's response the most effective one? Its regulatory environment has provided an ideal habitat for foreign illicit money, including from Russia, to take root and thrive. This is one of the factors that has made it particularly vulnerable to such attacks. Action on this would surely hurt far more.

This, and Britain's intelligence history, should surely provide ample room for public debate, and calls analysis for following internationally established protocols for action.

vidya.ram@thehindu.co.uk

5 THE SKRIPALS IN SALISBURY19th March, 2018

Britain's politics and diplomacy are in turmoil after the attack on a Russian double agent

When asked to defend his response in the U.K. Parliament to Prime Minister Theresa May's condemnation of the "unlawful use of force" by the Russian state against Britain, Labour Party leader Jeremy Corbyn told a television channel last week, "What I was asking were questions... That's what Oppositions are there for." An appetite for scrutiny appeared to be severely lacking in the British establishment as Mr. Corbyn was excoriated by those within and outside his party for failing to immediately endorse Ms. May's stance. Instead, he asked whether the government had responded to Russia's requests for a sample of the nerve agent, and whether there still remained a possibility that Russia had "negligently lost control" of the military-grade nerve agent, which Britain believes was used against former double agent Sergei Skripal and his daughter Yulia. Tough rhetoric appeared to be the order of the day as Foreign Secretary Boris Johnson virtually accused Russian President Vladimir Putin of masterminding the Salisbury attack, while Defence Secretary Gavin Williamson chucked aside diplomatic norms and told Russia to "go away" and "shut up".

Contd...



5 THE SKRIPALS IN SALISBURY

19th March, 2018

Diplomatic stand off

From a local story about two people slumped unconscious on a beach outside a shopping centre on March 4, the Skripals incident has rapidly spun into an diplomatic stand off. Britain and Russia are now engaged in tit-for-tat expulsions of diplomats, and Britain has withdrawn from all top-level official dialogue with Russia. Falling back into the old east-west fault lines, the U.K., Germany, France and the U.S. jointly decried the first “offensive use” of a nuclear weapon in Europe since the Second World War, firmly pointing the finger at Russia. Initial caution by some — notably France which had first said it would wait for evidence — gave way to unwavering certainty. With the nerve agent having been identified as being part of Russia’s Novichok nerve agent programme (dating back to the Soviet days), there were only two possibilities: either the nerve agent, judged to be several times as powerful as VX or Sarin, had been deployed by the Russian state or had fallen out of its hands.

Russia’s reaction, alongside denying the allegations, has been to question the methods deployed by the U.K. in its response. The setting of a midnight deadline for Russia to “explain itself” didn’t follow the protocol established under the Organisation for the Prohibition of Chemical Weapons (OPCW)’s Convention, for a joint investigation before judgment is passed. Speaking during the hastily arranged meeting of the United Nations Security Council, Russia’s Vassily Nebenzia accused Britain of being afraid of a “genuine professional discussion on the topic” by choosing the political forum of the Security Council rather than the expert body at The Hague to level its accusations and seek backing. It was also just last year that the OPCW, winner of the 2013 Nobel Peace Prize, participated in a ceremony on the completion of operations at the Kizner Chemical Weapons Destruction Facility, marking the full destruction of 39,967 metric tonnes of chemical weapons that the Soviet Union had possessed.

Contd...



5 THE SKRIPALS IN SALISBURY**19th March, 2018**

The landmark should have raised questions, given Britain's very recent past, and the Chilcot report in particular. Published in July 2016, the damning report by Sir John Chilcot pointed to grave errors made by British intelligence services in their assessment of Saddam Hussein's alleged weapons of mass destruction programme, which was used to make the case for the second Iraq War of 2003. "At no stage was the proposition that Iraq might no longer have chemical, biological or nuclear weapons or programmes identified and examined," the report noted.

Mr. Corbyn said in an article in The Guardian last week: "I have seen clear thinking in an international crisis overwhelmed by emotion and hasty judgments too many times. Flawed intelligence and dodgy dossiers led to the calamity of the Iraq invasion." He warned against resignation to a "new cold war of escalating arms spending, proxy conflicts across the globe and a McCarthyite intolerance of dissent."

Predictably, Mr. Corbyn has been accused of a long-standing softness towards Russia. This is particularly ironic as it is the Labour Party that has been pushing for a toughening of Britain's ability to impose sanctions on individuals, through the introduction of legislation on par with the U.S.'s Magnitsky Act. Named after an auditor who uncovered massive tax fraud but died in detention in Russia, the law allows asset freezes and denial of visas to those accused of human rights abuses, and was signed into law by former U.S. President Barack Obama in 2012. "We must also expose the flows of ill-gotten cash between the Russian state and billionaires who become stupendously rich by looting their country and subsequently use London to protect their wealth," Mr. Corbyn told MPs.

Contd...

5 THE SKRIPALS IN SALISBURY

19th March, 2018

Questions to both countries

Without doubt, there are many questions that need to be asked of Russia. Alongside the 2006 poisoning of former FSB officer Alexander Litvinenko, 14 deaths in London over the past 10 years have been linked to Russia. A BuzzFeed investigation said these deaths had raised suspicions among U.S. intelligence figures, despite not being ruled as suspicious by British police forces. On Friday, police launched a murder investigation into the death of Nikolai Glushkov, a Kremlin critic, at his home in London though there is no evidence linking this to the illness of the Skripals. An interview with Vil Mirzayanov, a Russian scientist who alerted the West to the existence of Novichok when he defected in the 1990s, told the Voice of America last week that since the programme had not been declared to the OPCW, it would not have the tools to detect it.

Contd...



5 RUSSIA SPY POISONING: WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU EXPEL A DIPLOMAT?

19th March, 2018

Russia has decided to expel 23 UK diplomats, in a tit-for-tat response to the UK's expulsion of 23 of its diplomats.

The British government announced plans to expel the Russian diplomats as part of its response to the Salisbury nerve agent attack.

But why do countries expel diplomats? And what happens when a diplomat is told to leave the country?

Why do countries expel diplomats?

Diplomats around the world are granted immunity in their host country - meaning they cannot be prosecuted there.

However, their right to stay in the host country can be withdrawn if they break the law, upset the host nation - or in the event of a diplomatic crisis, as between the UK and Russia right now.

The Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations governs how states interact. Under article 9 of the convention, the host country can "at any time and for any reason" declare a person to be *persona non grata* - unwelcome in their country.

Contd...



5 RUSSIA SPY POISONING: WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU EXPEL A DIPLOMAT?

19th March, 2018

Who decides who goes?

The host government decides which diplomats go and which ones stay.

The British ambassador was summoned by Russia on Saturday, and had to go and break the news to his staff. This is what the UK did to the Russian ambassador, and what has happened in the past.

UK and Malawi diplomats expelled

However John Everard, former UK ambassador to North Korea, says there is "no fixed way of telling diplomats" who stays and who goes.

Countries can summon the ambassador or issue a formal diplomatic note, he says. There is no law governing how to do it.

Patric Duddy, Former US ambassador to Venezuela, was back in Washington in 2008 when he was phoned by the US state department and told he could not return to his host nation - then-President Hugo Chavez had announced his expulsion on the news.

Contd...



5 RUSSIA SPY POISONING: WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU EXPEL A DIPLOMAT?

19th March, 2018

What happens when a diplomat is told to leave?

You leave, whenever the host country tells you to leave. Refusing to go is a breach of international treaties and could spark a major crisis.

"There's no bucking that," says Sir Christopher Meyer, former British ambassador to the US. "They have to meet our deadlines, we have to meet theirs."

While Russia has given the UK a week for its diplomats to leave, sometimes the time can be far less - 72 hours or even 24 hours.

In the 1960s, one British insurance firm even offered a policy to protect diplomats against sudden expulsion from Moscow.

Mr Everard, also never expelled himself, compares it to being told to move by a major transnational corporation.

"You won't do any work that week," he says, with children's schooling one of the major issues to consider.

"You say goodbye to as many friends and colleagues as you can manage, and if you are lucky you throw a party at the end of it."

The Russians being expelled from the UK seem to have found time to do this.

There is no official Foreign Office guidance to its staff about what to do in the event of expulsion, although Foreign Secretary Boris Johnson tweeted on Saturday that his priority now was "supporting those staff [who are] returning to the UK".

Contd...



5 RUSSIA SPY POISONING: WHAT HAPPENS WHEN YOU EXPEL A DIPLOMAT?

19th March, 2018

Can staff ever go back?

Sir Christopher was also never expelled himself, but he did work as a diplomat in the Soviet Union.

He explains it is "very rare" for a person to return to the host country once declared persona non grata.

Saying that though, he did know of someone who was able to go back to Russia after expulsion, applying and winning a posting there years later.

"There is no statutory period," he says. "But it's not common."

What happens on your return?

Expelled diplomats are not left waiting for the chance to return - they are reassigned "in due course", says Sir Christopher, even if they have specialised in one niche language.

"Most diplomats have a specialisation in one so-called 'hard language'," he says. "But you are expected to have broad knowledge."

"It doesn't mean you can't bring other skills to the Foreign Office."

Contd...



5

Russia spy poisoning: What happens when you expel a diplomat?



Russia has decided to expel 23 UK diplomats, in a 50-year-old response to the UK's expulsion of 23 of its diplomats.

The British government announced plans to expel the Russian diplomats as part of its response to the Salisbury nerve agent attack.

But why do countries expel diplomats? And what happens when a diplomat is told to leave the country?

The British government announced plans to expel the Russian diplomats as part of its response to the Salisbury nerve agent attack.

But why do countries expel diplomats? And what happens when a diplomat is told to leave the country?

• Russia to expel 23 UK diplomats in spy row

• Why the UK is expelling diplomats

Why do countries expel diplomats?

Diplomats around the world are granted immunity in their host country - meaning they cannot be prosecuted there.

However, their right to stay in the host country can be withdrawn if they break the law, expel the host nation - or in the event of a diplomatic crisis, as between the UK and Russia right now.

The Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations governs how states interact. Under article 9 of the convention, the host country can "at any time and for any reason" declare a person to be persona non grata - unwelcome in their country.

Who decides who goes?

The host government decides which diplomats go and which ones stay.

The British ambassador was summoned by Russia on Saturday, and had to go and break the news to his staff. This is what the UK did to the Russian ambassador, and what has happened in the past.

• UK and Russian diplomats expelled

However, John Eversard, former UK ambassador to North Korea, says there is "no best way of telling diplomats" who stays and who goes.

Countries can summon the ambassador or issue a formal diplomatic note, he says. There is no set governing how to do it.

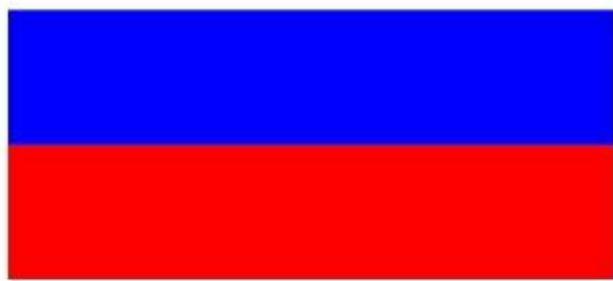


UPSC CSE – GS III

GS III ... Role of External State and Non state Actors in creating Challenges to Internal Security.

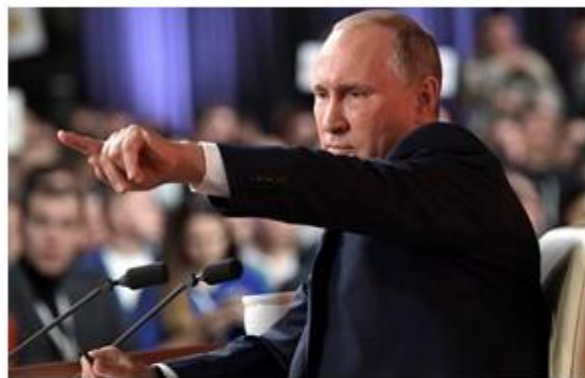


18th March, 2018



NEWS REPORT

Russia decided to expel 23 UK diplomats. It is tit-for-tat response to UK's expulsion of 23 of its diplomats.



WHY THE UK IS EXPELLING DIPLOMATS?

- 1 UK decided to expel 23 Russian diplomats. They are identified as “undeclared intelligence officers”.
- 2 Their job as told by UK is to conduct Espionage against Britain. This is the single biggest expulsion and it is about Hostile State Activity against United Kingdom

ESPIONAGE

Governments obtain Political and Military information through Spies.





DIPLOMATS AND IMMUNITY

- 1 Diplomats around the world are granted immunity in their host country. That means, they cannot be prosecuted there.
- 2 But, their right to stay in the host country can be withdrawn, if they break the law, upset the host nation or in the event of a diplomatic crisis.



VIENNA CONVENTION
ON DIPLOMATIC RELATIONS



**WHAT THE VIENNA
CONVENTION ON DIPLOMATIC
RELATIONS SAY?**

It governs how states interact. Under Article 9 of the convention, the host country can "at any time and for any reason" declare a person to be "Persona non grata" that means, they can say that they are unwelcome in their country.

The host Government decides, which diplomats to go and which one to stay. The countries can summon the ambassador or issue a formal diplomatic note. There is no law governing, how to do it.



VIENNA CONVENTION ON DIPLOMATIC RELATIONS

VIENNA CONVENTION

- The Vienna Convention on Diplomatic Relations of 1961 is an **International Treaty** that defines a framework for diplomatic relations between **independent countries**.
- It specifies the **privileges of a diplomatic mission** that enable diplomats to perform their function **without fear of coercion or harassment** by the host country.
- This forms the **legal basis for diplomatic immunity**.



WHAT HAPPENS WHEN A DIPLOMAT IS TOLD TO LEAVE?

Then, the diplomat is required to leave within the specified time. Refusing to go is a breach of international treaties and it could spark a major crisis.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

Amrita Naidu

D. Sunil Kumar

L. V. Krishna

D. Chaitanya

K. Srikanth

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 - 2 4 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9